9.15 Fat Embolism Syndrome

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I suddenly feel short of breath." **Objective** • Broke a long bone 2 days ago • SpO_2 86% • Petechiae across the chest • Confused	**ACTUAL** **Impaired gas exchange** related to fat emboli in the pulmonary circulation as evidenced by hypoxemia, dyspnea and petechiae.	SpO_2 94% or more.	• Give high-flow oxygen. • Sit him upright. • Call for urgent review and be ready for ventilation. • Move the fractured limb as little as possible.	SpO_2 on target: **goal met**.
Subjective • Family say • "He is confused." **Objective** • Disoriented • Restless	**ACTUAL** **Acute confusion** related to cerebral fat emboli and hypoxemia as evidenced by disorientation.	Oriented as his oxygen levels improve.	• Do neuro checks. • Put safety measures in place. • Give oxygen to target.	Oriented: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Hypoxemic • Heart rate fast	**RISK** **Risk for decreased cardiac output** as evidenced by risk factors: right heart strain.	Vital signs stable.	• Continuous ECG and vital signs monitoring. • Report low BP. • Give oxygen.	Stable: **goal met**.